

The Coca-Cola Company

You Get What You Pay For

We think KO's reiterated guide for +2-3% all-in EPS growth effectively embeds incremental wiggle room by not flowing through FX upside.

KO shares have handily outperformed YTD (+16.2% vs. XLP +3.3% and SPX -5.5%) and the 1Q print was highly affirming of the defensive play that many investors have sought via this name. We see no reason for a lower underlying 2025E EPS outlook (e.g. brands are healthy, consolidated momentum is solid with a proven ability to navigate puts and takes across the footprint), and instead see the decision to hold guidance even though FX pressures have eased as creating extra breathing room in a decidedly volatile environment. And even though shares command a healthy premium to the group already, we reiterate our Overweight rating given we think KO's OSG profile and scope of what's in its control to deliver on bottom line growth still scan highly attractive.

KO: Quarterly and Annual EPS (USD)

	2024	2025			2026			Change y/y	
FY Dec	Actual	Old	New	Cons	Old	New	Cons	2025	2026
Q1	0.72A	0.72E	0.73A	0.72E	0.79E	0.79E	0.77E	1%	8%
Q2	0.84A	0.85E	0.84E	0.85E	0.92E	0.91E	0.91E	0%	8%
Q3	0.77A	0.79E	0.80E	0.80E	0.87E	0.88E	0.86E	4%	10%
Q4	0.55A	0.57E	0.60E	0.60E	0.63E	0.64E	0.65E	9%	7%
Year	2.88A	2.94E	2.96E	2.96E	3.20E	3.23E	3.19E	3%	9%
P/E	25.1		24.4			22.4			

Consensus numbers are from Bloomberg received on 29-Apr-2025; 12:50 GMT
Source: Barclays Research

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KO **OVERWEIGHT**
Unchanged

U.S. CHPC & Beverages **NEUTRAL**
Unchanged

Price Target **USD 78.00**
raised 7% from USD 73.00

Price (29-Apr-25) **USD 72.35**

Potential Upside/Downside **+7.8%**

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

Market Cap (USD mn) **311363**

Shares Outstanding (mn) **4303.57**

Free Float (%) **81.70**

52 Wk Avg Daily Volume (mn) **15.4**

Dividend Yield (%) **2.82**

Return on Equity TTM (%) **40.98**

Current BVPS (USD) **6.09**

Source: Bloomberg

Price Performance **Exchange-NYSE**

52 Week range **USD 74.38-60.62**



Source: IDC
[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

NEUTRAL

The Coca-Cola Company (KO)

OVERWEIGHT

Income statement (\$mn)	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	CAGR
Revenue	46,897	47,993	50,759	53,664	4.6%
EBITDA (adj)	15,160	16,128	17,323	18,580	7.0%
EBIT (adj)	14,085	14,976	16,105	17,292	7.1%
Pre-tax income (adj)	15,333	16,165	17,410	18,719	6.9%
Net income (adj)	12,463	12,787	13,913	14,961	6.3%
EPS (adj) (\$)	2.88	2.96	3.23	3.47	6.3%
Diluted shares (mn)	4,320.3	4,313.0	4,313.0	4,313.0	-0.1%
DPS (\$)	1.94	2.04	2.12	2.21	4.4%
Margin and return data	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	Average
Gross margin (%)	61.1	61.3	61.6	61.9	61.4
EBITDA (adj) margin (%)	32.3	33.6	34.1	34.6	33.7
EBIT (adj) margin (%)	30.0	31.2	31.7	32.2	31.3
Pre-tax (adj) margin (%)	32.7	33.7	34.3	34.9	33.9
Net (adj) margin (%)	26.6	26.6	27.4	27.9	27.1
ROIC (%)	25.6	23.7	24.4	25.1	24.7
ROA (%)	11.4	11.7	12.0	12.2	11.8
ROE (%)	47.3	48.6	44.4	40.5	45.2
Balance sheet and cash flow (\$mn)	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	CAGR
Cash and equivalents	10,828	5,318	7,560	10,680	-0.5%
Total assets	100,549	101,442	107,289	113,428	4.1%
Short and long-term debt	44,522	44,522	44,522	44,522	0.0%
Total liabilities	74,177	75,122	75,927	76,485	1.0%
Net debt/(funds)	29,951	35,461	33,219	30,099	0.2%
Shareholders' equity	26,372	26,320	31,363	36,944	11.9%
Change in working capital	-6,234	-211	-370	-98	N/A
Cash flow from operations	6,805	11,738	13,593	14,988	30.1%
Capital expenditure	-2,064	-2,208	-2,183	-2,308	N/A
Free cash flow	4,741	9,530	11,410	12,681	38.8%
Valuation and leverage metrics	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	Average
P/E (adj) (x)	25.1	24.4	22.4	20.9	23.2
EV/sales (x)	6.9	6.9	6.4	6.0	6.6
EV/EBITDA (adj) (x)	21.4	20.4	18.9	17.4	19.5
EV/EBIT (adj) (x)	23.0	22.0	20.3	18.7	21.0
Equity FCF yield (%)	1.5	3.1	3.7	4.1	3.1
P/BV (x)	11.9	11.9	9.9	8.4	10.5
Dividend yield (%)	2.7	2.8	2.9	3.0	2.9
Total debt/capital (%)	62.8	62.8	58.7	54.7	59.7
Net debt/EBITDA (adj) (x)	2.0	2.2	1.9	1.6	1.9
Selected operating metrics	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	Average
Organic sales growth (%)	12.0	5.2	5.7	5.7	7.2
Volume growth (%)	2.0	1.1	3.0	3.4	2.4
Price growth (%)	11.0	4.1	2.7	2.3	5.0

Note: FY End Dec

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

Price (29-Apr-2025) **USD 72.35**
 Price Target **USD 78.00**

Why OVERWEIGHT?

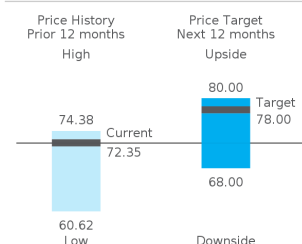
We expect KO's comprehensive transformation to re-accelerate the top and bottom line. As the company demonstrates an ability to sustainably deliver its algorithm, we expect more valuation credit to be given.

Upside case USD 80.00

Our upside case assumes that KO trades at a +10% premium to the more defensive, multi-national peers on upside 2025 EPS of \$3.00.

Downside case USD 68.00

Our downside case assumes that KO trades at a -5% discount to the more defensive, multi-national peers on downside 2025 EPS of \$2.93.

Upside/Downside scenarios

You Get What You Pay For

What to do with the stock: To us, the key takeaway from the 1Q print was that the telling combination of strategic and tactical clarity around the KO System is allowing for good visibility on top and bottom line, regardless of the external environment. To be sure, there were pluses and minuses in the quarter relative to what was expected at the start of the year, but all in, it is clear that the company is getting stronger at each turn. We see the decision to hold rather than raise full year EPS guidance as prudent given both the fluid nature of currency markets and the still nine months to go in a highly dynamic macroeconomic and geopolitical time.

Yesterday's print presented a different lens through which to appreciate the localized nature of KO System operations... We've frequently discussed the competitive advantage from having strong, local bottler partners in the System and what that means for co-investment and strategic joint business planning. For example, the System has effectively established a uniquely deep understanding of which ideas can work globally vs. regionally vs. locally, resulting in more targeted and effective reinvestment behind its bets – not to mention the advanced capability set that bottling partners have established to drive strong in-market execution in their respective footprints.

But this quarter commands a new (different) appreciation for the local nature of KO's operations. To start, the largely localized operations helped to keep the tariff impact from the global trade war to manageable levels. The local operations are also the cornerstone of KO's response to navigating US-brand boycotts – a playbook refined through the company's experience navigating tensions that arose from the Mideast conflict. The “Made In, Made By” campaign that originated in Türkiye not only helped to drive +DD volume growth and value share gains in that market during the quarter but also served as a blueprint for similar, recently rolled out efforts in Mexico and the US to help educate consumers of the fact that the KO System is a “a very profoundly local business as much as it looks like a global business”, as CEO James Quincey quipped yesterday. We were struck with some of the supporting stats shared, such as contributing 860k jobs and \$58bn of GDP in the US or 575k jobs and \$15bn of GDP in Brazil.

And this emphasis on local tactics was also readily apparent in the marketing activations this quarter. Case in point being the likes of Trademark Coke, Sprite and Minute Maid activations around the Lunar New Year in China, over 180mm servings of KO products being consumed at the Maha Kumbh Mela festival in India, and the Everyday Tasty Celebrations campaign that used local influencers to unite Trademark Coke with meal occasions in over 20 EMEA markets.

...At the same time, navigating the dynamic operating environment also once again put the diversity and agility of the KO System on full display. KO is surely well-owned (shares trading at north of 24x), and the results this quarter bore out why. The brands are healthy (continued NARTD value share gains at the consolidated level) and momentum was solid (UCV of +2% generally in-line with the multi-year trend). What's more, KO's diversified brand portfolio, channel exposure and geographic reach creates space for the business to navigate unexpected surprises in select markets while still delivering on big picture objectives. As much as we try to avoid parroting KO's “all-weather strategy” terminology, the reality is that the volatile backdrop over the last several years continue to highlight just how apt the description is – unlike several years ago when we might have instead characterized KO's efforts to drive consistent delivery on its outlook as a game of “whack a mole”).

With respect to agility, we've previously written about how the reduced complexity and better coordination across the System was making the System more agile in responding to, and making decisions on, real-time data ([Proof is in the P&L](#), 01/18/24). In this vein, we'd think 1) the coordination between KO and its domestic bottlers to strategize how to work through tariff headwinds and 2) the pivot in parts of US and Mexico to adjust consumer messaging to

emphasize the local perspective as detailed above both came far faster than would have been the case several years ago.

Changes to model. We continue to look for +5.2% OSG for 2025E (closer to the low end of KO's +5-6% guide), with ~50 bps shifted from volumes (now +0.7%) into price/mix (now +4.6%). Meanwhile, we raise our 2025E EPS +3c to \$2.96 (+2.8% YoY vs. KO's +2-3% guide) that reflect stronger operating profit partially offset by some incremental BTL de-leverage.

At the segment level, our OSG forecasts for EMEA, LatAm and North America are each generally unchanged, while APAC is ~150 bps higher and BIG is ~150 bps lower. We tempered our FX drag to -2.5% (from -3.1%) that is now squarely within KO's updated 2-3% guide, and layering in a ~90 bps drag from refranchising and inclusive of the remaining refranchising structural drag in 1Q, we look for net sales growth of +2.3%. We still model gross margin expansion of ~20 bps YoY to 61.3%, with SG&A at 30.1% of sales that brings operating margin to 31.2% (~+115 bps YoY). Looking below-the-line, we've tempered our equity income to reflect the partial sale of KO's stake in CCEP and raised our net interest expense by ~\$20mm. In aggregate, the BTL adjustments reflects a ~1c drag that partially offset a ~4c tailwind from stronger operating profit now embedded in our model.

We are raising our PT to \$78. Our valuation methodology assumes a +HSD% premium to the more defensive, multi-national peers (a ~26.2x multiple) on a P/E basis on our 2025 EPS estimate of \$2.96. Our prior price target of \$73 assumed a +MSD% premium to immediate peers or ~24.9x multiple on a P/E basis on our CY25 EPS estimate of \$2.94. We've widened our assumed premium in light of KO's more attractive sales growth and flexible profit growth outlook.

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 29-Apr-2025, USD 72.35), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)
Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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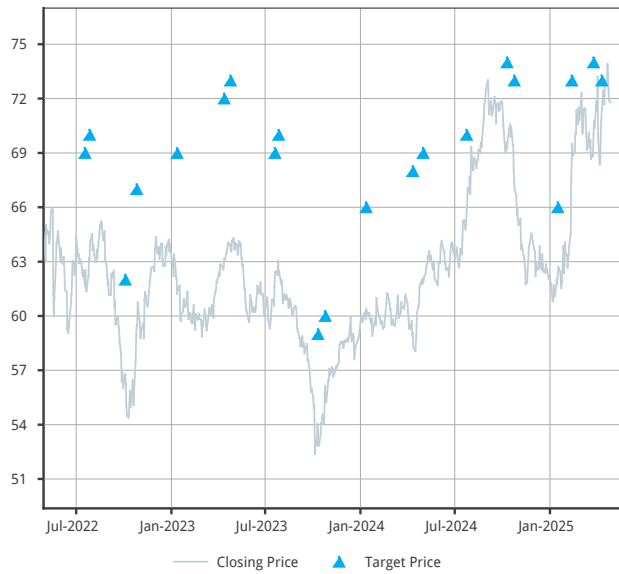
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 72.35** (29-Apr-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 29-Apr-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
11-Apr-2025	70.76		73.00
26-Mar-2025	68.95		74.00
12-Feb-2025	67.60		73.00
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00

On 29-Apr-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 74.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$78 is based on a ~26.2x P/E reflecting a +HSD% premium to the more defensive, multinational peers on our CY25 EPS estimate of \$2.96.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results

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